

The Iconoclast

As though someone at this university might actually read

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Treks on the beach-by the Placeman

I am on the beach after a storm. The tempest itself is far out at sea now, but still it makes waves. I am currently releasing tension by screaming at these waves that tower over my head as they crash into the sand. This is magic. Just me and mother nature hanging out, talking in a way that seems to come with the lunacy of the full moon. A "sensible" modern person might say this is a waste of valuable stock market time. This brings me to something that has been troubling me (c.n.> what doesn't bother this guy?). What if the things that happen in our lives that seem like "coincidences" are really the little things that balance out the good and bad in life. They are too often overlooked. Perhaps they are important. Luck, or is it chance? Or what if it is actually the energy of an individual causing the tides of events to change. Most of us don't feel these are important. Indeed everyday, modern life doesn't have time for such things. When was the last time you saw a face in the leaves of a tree (or even saw a real naturally growing tree for that matter--not one of those fake landscaping things that frown at you because they don't like being the only tree on a lawn treated with harsh chemicals to keep it green) and dismissed it as a trick of the eye? Sure, magic to most people is focusing one's will to affect one's reality. But what is the source of this power we use? Perhaps it is in the universe and perhaps it's in the individual, perhaps it is a vitamin that we take from our daily foodstuffs --something in the methylpropylate in our shampoo. Or maybe the only real magic is a stage magician doing tricks. So what does one do? I say pick a belief and have faith. If magic isn't real, so what--you lose nothing if it was never real. But, if it was real.... abracadabra! The magic has worked. If you would like, this same principle can be applied to gods. I feel it has become "cool" to deny the existence of gods/God. Some say the age of miracles occurred 2000 years ago and it is gone, with no need for it remaining. What if miracles are the coincidences that we brush off so easily? It takes more courage to have faith than to deny the existence of gods. God, faeries, honest politicians, virtuous lawyers, jumbo shrimp. Think for yourself for goodness sake, never give that up, for anything. But remember, this means questioning both Christians and atheists and televangelists and Bill Clinton, and Newt Gingrich, and the hippie down the street who answers every question with "what?" What if we all worshipped that same gods? What if they are all wearing different masks? Wouldn't that mean that we're not all as different as we think we are? Jesus, and Muhammed, sons of the same father? The bible could be just the selfishness of man coming through as usual, especially where it says that Jesus was the only begotten son. If we try to see similarities instead of differences, they could bring us closer together. We could all arrange a "shave Newt Gingrich's head" drive, or a throttle Saddam Hussein bake a thon. Always seek a balance: a happy medium, my father would say.

Simply Rubbish

--From the desk of Just Some Guy

Take a moment before you read the rest of my introduction to my world, and look around you. Finished? Good. The world we live in is full of stuff that...well, for lack of a better term, just plain sucks. The trash of the world is everywhere, and I don't mean just litter. People, places, things; animal, vegetable, mineral. Life can be so much easier and simpler and more fun if we acknowledge this trash and stay away from it. However, I have taken it upon myself for the good of the world, to find all of this trash and point it out to everyone. I don't want to tuck it away in a corner of the world and forget about it. I want to put all of the trash in a big heap on your doorstep. I want to put neon signs all over it and paint it obnoxious colours. I want it to smell bad so when you walk down the path of life and see this stinky bright, huge, conglomerate of every facet of our society you will steer clear of it. You will tell your friends to stay away from it.

That's where I come in.

I am Just Some Average Guy. An average Joe. A commoner just like you. I'm going to get the ol' hip waders down from the garage and get right to work putting this stuff where it belongs: In The Dumpster. It will not be an easy task. Like any crusader for the good of the common man (or shall I say good of the common person? Good of the common organism? Yes, good of the common organism. Anyway) I will face adversity. Some of you will not agree with what I put into The Dumpster, and you are entitled to your opinion. I am not here to use this space as a forum for my opinions, but rather to show you the correct opinions. I am merely showing you the correct path to take at certain forks in that that overly-cliched highway of life. If you choose to take a different path, that is your decision. Just don't come crying to me.

How do you thank Just Some Guy for taking on such a monumental problem of our world? No need to. Knowing that I am ridding the world of the things that clog the pipes of our social contentment is gratitude enough for me. But feel free to write me and say "Thanks Just Some Guy." When you see me with my rubber yellow gloves cleaning life's toilet bowl, give me a pat on the back. When you see me on the side of the road with my bright orange jacket and my little stick with the point on the end picking up trash, honk your horn and wave to me. If you see me in your neighborhood doing whatever, feel free to buy me a cold one and just say "Thanks." Just don't make it a Coors Light, please.

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TODAY ON THE SALLY CARNY BEY SHOW:

MORE COMPACTED HUMAN-TRASH FROM THE "BIBLE BELT" COMPLAINING ABOUT SPOUSES WHO HAD SEX WITH THEIR BEST FRIEND'S ROOMMATE'S TRANSEXUAL CROSS-DRESSED STATUE OF THE VIRGIN MARY ON HOT DOG DAY AT WORK UNDER THE WATER COOLER WITHOUT A CONDOM.

Talk show addiction will kill.

THERE ARE NO IF'S AND OR BUTTS. This psuedo-politically correct GARBAGE THAT daytime television feeds its audience is ATROCIOUS, and WHAT WORRIES AN AVERAGE THINKING AMERICAN like MYSELF is THAT SOME PEOPLE CUT SCHOOL AND CALL OUT SICK FROM WORK TO WATCH THESE VILE DISPLAYS OF THE MODERN DAY FREAK SHOW. How responsible is it TO AMERICA TO PORTRAY A WOMAN WITH TWO HEADS? WHAT kind of STATEMENT is THAT TO THE AUDIENCE?

PERHAPS THE ARGUMENT CAN BE MADE, THAT THESE SHOWS OPEN THE PUBLIC MIND TO ALL THE POSSIBILITIES THIS WORLD HAS TO OFFER. I ask: is it PROPER ETIQUETTE TO GAWK AT LESBIANS professing their love TO THEIR ROOMMATES IN FRONT OF A TELEVISION AUDIENCE, TO EMBARRASS THEM AND DEFACE THEIR BETTER NAME WHEN THE LOVEES HAVE TO ADMIT THEY ARE ATTRACTED TO THE NEIGHBOR'S MOTHER? Isn't this A SEXUAL deviation called "VOYEURISM?"

I ARGUE THAT THESE SHOWS ACTUALLY ENCROACH ON LIBERALISM by showing RADICALISM. It would SEEM, TO AN AVERAGE VIEWER, THAT all people WITH A SOUTHERN ACCENT ARE ISCESTUOUS CROSS-BREEDING CLOSED-MINDED FUNDAMENTALIST deviants WITH A FETISH FOR CHEATING ON THEIR S.O.'s WITH THE MOST BIZARRE SEXUAL PARTNERS THIS WORLD HAS EVER SEEN.

CAN YOU SAY: LET'S NARROW THE SCOPE OF EXPERIENCE by KEEPING THE VIEWERS GLUED TO THE SCREEN? Kids ARE BEING babysat BY THEIR TELEVISION SETS, AND NOW WE HAVE A GENERATION OF CHILDREN THINKING THAT GREY-HAIRED SKINHEADS THAT HAVE MARRIED TWELVE WOMEN ARE AN AVERAGE, AND people WHO ACTUALLY EARN THEIR MONEY BY WORKING AT MORE THAN JUST BAD ACTING AND SCREAMING AT A CAMERA ARE A MINORITY. Talk ABOUT developing A FALSE SENSE OF REALITY. THE FRIGHTENING thing is THAT THERE IS A PROPENSITY TO ACTUALLY BELIEVE THAT THESE people AND THESE LIVES EXIST. SOME people GROW TEARY-EYED WHEN AN UNREVEALED LOVE RECIPROCATES THE AFFECTION AND EMPATHIZE WITH NON-EXISTENT STORIES OF UNREQUITED LOVE..

THE TRUTH OF THE MATTER IS THAT people HAVE SO LITTLE IMAGINATION OF THEIR OWN, THAT THEY BELIEVE THEIR life TO BE BORING AND TRITE. SINCE TELEVISION OFFERS A MORE INTERESTING LIFESTYLE THAN ONE'S OWN, ONE CAN BEGIN LIVING life THROUGH THE CAMERA EYE. People, GET A life! IT CAN'T BE ALL THAT BAD TO STUDY AT A UNIVERSITY WHERE YOUR DEGREE WILL MEAN SOMETHING (ALTHOUGH YOU WON'T HAVE LEARNED MUCH). NO ONE'S life CAN BE THAT BORING THAT TALK SHOWS ARE A REALISTIC ALTERNATIVE. THERE ARE SOME REALLY NEAT, AND INTERESTING people YOU CAN MEET IN PERSON, AND NOT GET INTO A YELLING MATCH. AND HERE'S AN idea, REHEARSE YOUR OWN LINES FOR THE MUSICAL OF Life. MAKE YOUR OWN sully LIVES EXTRAORDINARY. HAVE YOU FORGOTTEN THE CLICHE "Carpe Diem?"

Grow Where You're Planted Dammit!

What if
placing new ones
someone came and uprooted
all your words to a great poem,
where he found it
aesthetically pleasing to put them?

I call this my lawn, my property, my own little acreage, and i am watching it be redefined by landscapers.
I am so proud of the trees that rebel and wither to the dismay of the high class buy anything i want owners who plotted a specific piece of the lawn just for that particular tree, just as i revere the branches and flowers that shoot out of the bloody stumps of aged wonder.
And yet, they persist. If at first they don't succeed they try try again. So another tree is planted, and another, and yet another. And still, they die and wither, and fade. Ha! Stupid silly humans didn't notice there was a powerline underneath the ground electrocuting the roots. Then we curse the trees for letting its roots damage our water mains, and encroaching on the space we deemed for flowers only. And then those nasty roots that stick out of the ground-be gone nasty roots, we shall have none of you. And we cut off arms and legs at our convenience, we prune and shape, and keep water from them so they do not grow. Quick, better let nature know that we are controlling her, she's got no sway over us! It looks more like we are trying to convince ourselves in the midst of a hurricane as we plant the tree where we want it, and tell the grass where it is allowed to grow that we are in control. it wouldn't be so bad is the landscapers didn't make things so damned ugly.

THE PAPAL DECREE OF THE WEEK

THOU SHALT NOT WATCH TELEVISION UNTIL THE X-FILES SEASON PREMIERE BEGINS. THEN, THOU SHALT ONLY WATCH THE FOLLOWING TELEVISION PROGRAMMING: THE X-FILES, MILLENNIUM, SESAME STREET, MAX HEADROOM, MUPPETS TONITE AND STAR TREK VOYAGER. FOR THE CABLE IMPAIRED (WHO ARE OF COURSE NOT INCAPABLE, BUT SPECIAL), THEY ARE PERMITTED TO WATCH THE NEW OUTER LIMITS IN PLACE OF MAX HEADROOM DUE TO ITS CABLE LINK NECESSITY. POPE JOHN JACOB